

StaffDesk

Complete User Guide

A role-based workforce management platform for tasks, people, time, performance, and operations.

Covers every feature in the application: what it does, who can use it, and how to use it step by step.

Live demo: <https://staffdesk-production.up.railway.app/login.html>

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1. Getting Started — Logging In & Roles

StaffDesk is accessed through a web browser. The sign-in page is served at the `/login.html` path of your StaffDesk deployment (for example, the hosted demo at `staffdesk-production.up.railway.app/login.html`).

How to log in

- 1 Open the StaffDesk login page in your browser.
- 2 Enter the email address and password provided by your administrator.
- 3 Click **Log In**. On success you land on the **Dashboard** (My Work) view.
- 4 Your name and avatar appear top-right; click **■ Logout** at any time to end your session.

Note: If you don't have an account yet, ask an Admin to create an employee record for you and link it to a login — self-registration is not available.

Understanding roles

Every screen and button in StaffDesk adapts to your role. The five roles are:

Role	What they can access
Admin	Full organization-wide access: people, departments, planning, analytics, platform/operations, and sys
Manager	Team-level task, leave, and performance oversight for their department(s).
HR Admin	Performance review cycles, calibration sessions, and the competency library.
Auditor	Read-only access to the full audit trail.
Member	Personal task list, timesheets, leave requests, and their own performance reviews.

Note: Throughout this guide, each feature lists "Who can do this" so you know what to expect on your account.

2. Dashboard (My Work)

Who can do this: everyone — content shown adapts to your role.

The Dashboard is the screen you land on after logging in. It's your personal home base, summarizing tasks assigned to you and, if you are a Manager or Admin, a wider view of your team's work.

- 1 Click **■ Dashboard** in the top navigation at any time to return here.
- 2 Review your assigned tasks and any items awaiting your action.
- 3 Use the notification bell (■) in the header to see unread alerts — click it to open the notifications panel.

3. Departments

Who can do this: Admin (create/edit); everyone can view.

Departments are the organizational units that employees, tasks, SLA policies, and calendars belong to.

Creating a department

- 1 Go to the **Departments** tab.
- 2 Click **+ New Department**.
- 3 Enter a **Name** and **Location**.
- 4 Click **Create**.

Editing a department

- 1 From the Departments list, open the department you want to change.
- 2 Update the **Name** and/or **Location** fields.
- 3 Click **Update** to save, or **Cancel** to discard changes.

Opening a department also takes you to its detail page (use ← **Back to Departments** to return), which lists department-specific settings such as triagers and the default Definition of Done used by task templates.

4. Employees

Who can do this: Admin (create/edit); Managers can view their team.

The Employees directory holds every person in the organization, their job title, department, seniority level, and reporting manager.

Creating an employee

- 1 Go to the **Employees** tab and click **+ New Employee**.
- 2 Fill in **Full Name**, **Job Title**, **Department**, and **Seniority Level**.
- 3 Click **Create**.

Editing an employee

- 1 Select the employee from the directory.
- 2 Update **Full Name**, **Job Title**, **Department**, **Seniority Level**, **Manager**, or the **Active** toggle.
- 3 Click **Update** to save.

Handing over tasks

When an employee is going inactive or leaving a role, their open tasks can be reassigned in bulk instead of one-by-one.

- 1 Open the employee's record.
- 2 Click **■ Handover Tasks**.
- 3 Choose the employee who should receive the outstanding tasks and confirm.

Note: Use **■ Prev / Next ■** at the bottom of the directory to page through a long employee list.

5. Seniority Levels

Who can do this: Admin.

Seniority Levels define a ranked career ladder (e.g., Junior, Mid, Senior, Lead) used on employee profiles and, indirectly, in capacity planning.

- 1 Go to the **Seniority Levels** tab and click **+ New Level**.
- 2 Enter a **Name**, numeric **Rank** (lower/higher determines ordering), and an optional **Description**.
- 3 Click **Create**.
- 4 To change a level later, select it, edit its Name, Rank, Description, or Active status, and click **Update**.

6. Tasks

Who can do this: everyone — visibility and actions depend on role and assignment.

The Tasks board is the core of StaffDesk: a full task list with filtering, bulk actions, comments, checklists, and saved views.

Creating a task

- 1 Go to the **Tasks** tab and click **+ New Task**.
- 2 Fill in **Title**, **Description**, **Department**, **Priority**, **Assignee**, **Due Date**, **Estimate (minutes)**, and comma-separated **Tags**.
- 3 Click **Create Task**.

Editing a task

- 1 Open a task from the list to view its details.
- 2 Update any field (Title, Description, Department, Priority, Assignee, Due Date, Estimate).
- 3 Click **Save Changes**.

Filtering and saved views

Use the filter controls above the task list (by department, priority, assignee, tag, etc.) to narrow what you see. To reuse a filter combination:

- 1 Set up the filters you want.
- 2 Click  **Save View**, give it a Name, choose its Visibility (private or shared), and confirm.
- 3 Click **Reset** at any time to clear active filters back to the default view.

Bulk actions

Select multiple tasks (checkboxes in the list) to apply an action to all of them at once — for example reassigning, changing priority, or archiving a batch of tasks — using the bulk action controls above the list.

Comments, checklist items, and acceptance criteria

Inside an open task, you can add comments to discuss progress, tick off checklist items that were copied from a template, and mark acceptance criteria as met before the task is considered done.

Approvals, closure, and rework

Depending on how a task or its department is configured, completing a task may require a manager's approval before it's marked Done (Approval), a formal Closure step, or may be sent back for Rework if it does not meet the acceptance criteria — these actions appear as buttons on the task detail view when applicable to your role and the task's current state.

7. Task Requests

Who can do this: everyone can submit; Managers/Admins triage.

Task Requests are an informal intake queue for work that hasn't been turned into a full task yet — useful for ad-hoc asks that need review before becoming an official task.

Submitting a request

- 1 Go to the **Task Requests** tab and click **+ Submit Request**.
- 2 Fill in **Title**, **Description**, **Department**, **Desired By** date, and a **Business Justification**.
- 3 Click **Submit**.

Reviewing requests

Use the **My Requests** tab to track requests you've submitted, and the **Triage Queue** tab (visible to Managers/Admins) to review incoming requests and convert approved ones into tasks.

8. SLA Administration

Who can do this: Admin.

Service Level Agreement (SLA) policies set response and resolution time targets for tasks, by department and priority.

- 1 Go to the **SLA** tab and click **+ New Policy**.
- 2 Choose the **Department** and **Priority** the policy applies to.
- 3 Enter the **Response Target (minutes)** and **Resolution Target (minutes)**.
- 4 Click **Create**.

Click **■ Evaluate All** to re-run SLA compliance checks across existing tasks against the current policies (useful after changing a target).

9. Delegations

Who can do this: Managers and above delegate their own authority; everyone can see delegations affecting them.

Delegation lets a manager temporarily hand a specific scope of authority (e.g., approving leave, managing tasks) to another employee — useful for vacations or coverage periods.

- 1 Go to the **Delegations** tab and click **+ New Delegation**.
- 2 Choose the **Delegate** (the person receiving authority) and the **Scope** being delegated.
- 3 Set the **Start Date** and **End Date** for the delegation window.
- 4 Add an optional **Reason**.
- 5 Click **Create**.

The page also shows **My Active Delegations** (authority you've handed off) and **Delegated To Me** (authority you've temporarily received).

10. Task Templates & Recurring Tasks

Who can do this: Admin.

Templates define a reusable task blueprint. Attaching a recurrence rule to a template makes StaffDesk generate real tasks from it automatically on a schedule (daily, weekly, or monthly).

Step 1 — Create a template

- 1 Go to the **Templates & Recurrence** tab and click **+ New Template**.
- 2 Enter a **Name**, choose the **Department**, and add an optional **Description**.
- 3 Set the **Title Pattern** for generated tasks — you can use placeholders like {date}, {year}, {month}, {day}, and {week}, e.g. "Standup - {date}".
- 4 Set **Default Priority**, **Default Description**, **Default Assignee**, **Estimate (minutes)**, comma-separated **Tags**, **Checklist Items**, and **Default Acceptance Criteria**.
- 5 Click **Save Template**.

Step 2 — Attach a recurrence rule

Still on the template, fill in the **Recurrence Rule** section:

- 1 Set **Frequency** to **Daily**, **Weekly**, or **Monthly** (leaving it at **None** means no schedule is created — the template stays a manual, one-off blueprint).
- 2 For Weekly, choose the **Days of Week** (0 = Sunday ... 6 = Saturday). For Monthly, choose the **Day of Month**.
- 3 Set the **Rule Start Date** (today or a past date so the rule is immediately active) and, optionally, a **Rule End Date**.
- 4 Choose the **Non-Working Day Policy** — how an occurrence that falls on a weekend/holiday is handled: shift to the Next Working Day, the Previous Working Day, or Skip it entirely.
- 5 Click **Save Template** again to store the rule.

Step 3 — Generate and materialize tasks

Recurring tasks are produced in two stages: first StaffDesk schedules upcoming **occurrences** for a rule, then it turns due occurrences into real tasks.

- 1 Click **■ Generate Now** to have StaffDesk compute the next scheduled occurrence dates for all active rules.
- 2 Click **■ Materialize Pending** to actually create tasks for any occurrence that is now due (dated today or earlier).

Note: An occurrence only turns into a task once its date has arrived. If you create a rule with a future Start Date, nothing is generated until that date. Check the **Recurrence Rules** and **Recent Occurrences** lists at the bottom of the page to see what's scheduled and what has already been generated.

11. Leave & Absence

Who can do this: everyone can request; Managers approve for their team.

Requesting leave

- 1 Go to the **Leave & Absence** tab and click **+ Request Leave**.
- 2 Choose the **Type** of leave (e.g., vacation, sick).
- 3 Toggle **Partial day** if you're only taking part of a day off.
- 4 Set the **Start** and **End** dates.
- 5 Add an optional **Note**.
- 6 Click **Submit**.

Approving leave

Managers see a **Pending Approvals** list for their team's leave requests and can approve or reject each one.

The **Leave Records** list below shows the history of all leave for the team.

Cancelling leave

From your leave list, a request that is still **Requested** or already **Approved** shows a **Cancel** button to withdraw it.

12. Capacity & Availability

Who can do this: Managers and Admin.

This view compares how much work is planned against how much time is actually available per person, over a date range — useful for spotting over- or under-loaded team members before committing to deadlines.

- 1 Go to the **Capacity & Availability** tab.
- 2 Choose the **Department**, the **From** and **To** dates, and an **Overhead %** (a buffer subtracted from raw available hours for meetings/admin work).
- 3 Click **Load** to see the **Availability** and **Workload** panels for that period.

13. Timesheets

Who can do this: everyone tracks their own; Managers review their team's.

- 1 Go to the **Timesheets** tab.
- 2 Pick the **Week start** date and click **Load Week** to see (or log) time entries for that week.
- 3 When the week is complete, click **Submit Week** to send it for review.

The **My Timesheets** list shows your own submission history; Managers additionally see a **Pending Review** list of team timesheets awaiting sign-off.

14. Analytics & Reporting

Who can do this: everyone sees My Work; Managers/Admins get Department, Flow and Organisation views.

Analytics provides four dashboards, selected as tabs at the top of the page:

- **My Work** — your own assigned tasks, WIP & aging, SLA performance, and quality metrics.
- **Department** — the same metrics rolled up for a department (Managers/Admins).
- **Flow** — throughput, arrivals, flow metrics and time-in-status series across the team (Managers/Admins).
- **Organisation** — an organization-wide overview and period/department comparison (Admin only).

How to use it

- 1 Choose a tab (**My Work**, **Department**, **Flow**, or **Organisation**).
- 2 Set the **Department** (and, for comparisons, a **Compare department**), the **From/To** date range, **Duration basis**, **Granularity**, and **Overhead %** as needed.
- 3 Click **Load** to refresh the charts and tables.
- 4 Click **Export CSV** to download the current view's data.
- 5 Admins can click **Rebuild range** to force analytics to recompute rollups for the selected period.

15. Working Calendars

Who can do this: Admin.

Working Calendars define business hours, time zones, and holidays used across scheduling features (like recurrence and SLA targets) to distinguish working days from non-working days.

Creating a calendar

- 1 Go to the **Calendars** tab and click **+ New Calendar**.
- 2 Enter a **Name**, **Timezone**, **Start hour**, and **End hour**.
- 3 Toggle **Org default** if this calendar should apply organization-wide unless overridden.
- 4 Click **Create**.

Adding holidays

- 1 Select a **Calendar ID**.
- 2 Under **Add Holiday**, set the **Date** and a **Name**, and toggle **Recurs annually** if it repeats every year (e.g. a fixed public holiday).
- 3 Click **Add**.

Department overrides

Under **Department Calendar Override**, choose a **Department** and set a specific **Calendar ID** for it (leave blank to fall back to the org default), then click **Save**.

16. Performance Management

Who can do this: everyone sees their own reviews (Mine); Managers assess and calibrate; HR Admin runs cycles and manages competencies.

Performance Management is organized into tabs, tailored to your role:

- **Mine** — your own self-assessments and past reviews.
- **Assess** — reviews you owe as a manager for your direct reports.
- **Cycle** — review cycle status and progress (HR Admin sets up cycles; Managers track theirs).
- **Calibration** — a session for managers/HR to compare and align ratings across a team before finalizing them.
- **Goals** — set and track individual goals tied to a review period.
- **Competencies** — the shared competency framework (skills/behaviors) used across all reviews (HR Admin maintains this library).

Completing a self-assessment

- 1 Go to the **Performance** tab; you'll land on the **Mine** panel.
- 2 Open the active review cycle and fill in your self-assessment against the listed competencies and goals.
- 3 Submit it for your manager's review.

Completing a manager assessment

- 1 Switch to the **Assess** tab.
- 2 Select a direct report's pending review.
- 3 Complete the manager assessment and submit it.

Setting goals

- 1 Switch to the **Goals** tab.
- 2 Create a goal tied to the current review period and track its progress over time.

Note: HR Admins additionally see an HR panel for launching and managing review cycles and editing the competency library; Admins/Auditors see a read-only technical/admin view rather than the full self-service workflow.

17. Notifications

Who can do this: everyone.

The bell icon (■) in the header shows a badge with your unread notification count.

- 1 Click the bell to open the notifications panel.
- 2 Review new alerts — task assignments, approvals needed, leave decisions, SLA breaches, and similar events.
- 3 Click **Mark all read** to clear the unread badge.

18. Operations & System Health

Who can do this: Admin only.

The Operations dashboard gives a live, technical view of the platform's health: the background job queue, system alerts, and audit chain integrity.

- 1 Open the **Operations** view (Admin navigation).
- 2 Review the summary panel for overall status at a glance, including the **Audit chain** health indicator (PASS/FAIL) confirming the tamper-evident audit log has not been altered.
- 3 Check the **Jobs** list for background jobs (e.g. recurring task generation, analytics rollups) — filter by state such as **DEAD** to find failed jobs.
- 4 Click **Requeue** next to a dead job to retry it.
- 5 Review the **Alerts** list for anything requiring attention.

19. Security & Audit Trail

StaffDesk keeps a hash-chained, tamper-evident audit log of key actions across the system (task changes, approvals, leave decisions, admin changes, and more). Each entry is cryptographically linked to the one before it, so any attempt to alter history breaks the chain and is detectable.

Who can do this: Auditor role has full read-only access to the audit trail; Admins can see chain integrity status on the Operations dashboard (see Section 18).

Session management and role-based access control (RBAC) are enforced automatically throughout the app — every screen and action is limited to what your assigned role permits, as summarized in the Roles table below.

20. Roles at a Glance (Reference Table)

Feature	Admin	Manager	HR Admin	Auditor	Member
Dashboard / My Work	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Departments (create/edit)	✓	—	—	—	—
Employees (create/edit)	✓	view team	—	—	—
Seniority Levels	✓	—	—	—	—
Tasks	✓	✓ (team)	—	—	✓ (own)
Task Requests	✓	✓ triage	—	—	✓ submit
SLA Administration	✓	—	—	—	—
Delegations	✓	✓	—	—	view own
Templates & Recurrence	✓	—	—	—	—
Leave & Absence	✓	✓ approve	—	—	✓ request
Capacity & Availability	✓	✓	—	—	—
Timesheets	✓	✓ review	—	—	✓ own
Analytics — My Work	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Analytics — Dept/Flow	✓	✓	—	—	—
Analytics — Organisation	✓	—	—	—	—
Working Calendars	✓	—	—	—	—
Performance — self	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Performance — assess/calibrate	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Performance — cycles/competencies—		—	✓	—	—
Operations & System Health	✓	—	—	—	—
Audit Trail	chain status only	—	—	✓ full	—

This guide reflects the current StaffDesk feature set. If your account doesn't show a feature listed here, check with your Admin — access is controlled entirely by your assigned role.